

Cover story **MATRIMONY**

The average urban Indian male is showing a new sensibility in discarding traditional attributes in favour of more practical ones, as he redefines his choice for the ideal bride, recent surveys show



a *suitable* *girl*

|By Damayanti Datta|

When he was 28, his parents looked for a girl from the same caste. When he turned 34, they looked simply for a Hindu girl. And now that he is nearing 40, they just want him to find "a female". His father, a retired IIT professor, doesn't understand what he wants. His mother, a university teacher, knows what he does not want. Confused and perplexed, they have retreated to the background, leaving the quest up to him. And 37-year-old B.K. Krishna, a techie based in Hyderabad, is surfing online matrimonial sites looking for a woman he would feel "comfortable" with. That definitely rules out those who are "young and immature", whose

